As per usual status(adjusted) NSS 66th round 2009-10, the unemployment rate (per 1000) among the major states is the *lowest* in Gujarat (18) and *highest* in Kerala (73) and Bihar (73) in urban areas and the lowest in Rajasthan (4) and again highest in Kerala (75) in rural areas.

The low unemployment rate in rural areas in Rajasthan may partly be due to high absorption of MGNREGA funds in the state. Kerala, which has performed well in terms of most indicators, performs less in terms of unemployment (both rural and urban). This may be due to the higher level of education in Kerala resulting in people not opting for manual jobs as observed by some studies.

Health

Kerala is the *best* performer in terms of *life expectancy* at birth for both males (71.5 years) and females (76.9 years) whereas Assam is the worst performer for both males (61 years) and females (63.2 years) during 2006-10. *Infant mortality rate* (IMR) in 2011 is the lowest in Kerala (12) and highest in Madhya Pradesh (59) against the national average of 44. *Birth rate* is lowest in Kerala (15.2) and highest in Uttar Pradesh (27.8) against the national average of 21.8. Death rate is lowest in West Bengal (6.2) and highest in Odisha (8.5) against the national average of 7.1.

Education

Madhya Pradesh has the *highest* gross enrolment ratio (GER) (6-13 years) in 2010-11 while Assam has the lowest. *Pupil-teacher ratios* in primary and middle/basic schools are the lowest in Himachal Pradesh and high in states like Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.

Financial Inclusion

In terms of decadal growth rate in bank branches, Haryana (59.5 per cent) has the *highest* growth and Bihar the lowest (14.4 per cent). Among worth eastern states Assam is placed at 16.5 per cent. Himachal Pradesh (89.1 per cent) has the highest percentage households availing of banking services while Assam (44.1 per cent) is the lowest followed by Bihar (44.4 per cent). Thus, in terms of both these financial inclusion indicators, Bihar's performance is *among the worst*.

Key Social Sector Programmes